disagree. After that, we signed the INF treaty. I was proud to be part of a genuinely historic moment, something I'd been striving for since 1981, and I was very happy.

Before the signing, Gorbachev and I each made brief remarks. "We can only hope," I said,

> that this history-making agreement will not be an end in itself but the beginning of a working relationship that will enable us to tackle the other urgent issues before us: strategic offensive nuclear weapons, the balance of conventional forces in Europe, the destructive and tragic regional conflicts that beset so many parts of our globe, and respect for the human and natural rights God has granted to all men.

Not only did the INF treaty provide for the elimination of an entire class of nuclear weapons, I said, it contained teeth to assure compliance. "We have listened to the wisdom of an old Russian maxim:

"Dovorey no provorey—trust, but verify."

"You repeat that at every meeting," Gorbachev said, to which I said, "I like it."

Gorbachev then made some remarks I agreed with:

> For everyone, and, above all, for our two great powers, the treaty whose text is on this table offers a big chance at last to get onto the road leading away from the threat of catastrophe. It is our duty to take full advantage of that chance and move together toward a nuclear-free world, which holds out for our children and grandchildren and for their children and grandchildren the promise of a fulfilling and happy life without fear and without a senseless waste of resources on weapons of destruction . . . may December 8, 1987, become a date that will be inscribed in the history books, a date that will mark the watershed separating